FIGHTERBASE

# Low-carb

## Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. Fewer starchy carbs, more protein and veg.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

# How to use this food list

This food list is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Low-carb**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

## The colour key

| Green | Amber | Red | Blue |
|---|---|---|---|
| Allowed. Fits this style. | In moderation, small amounts or some versions. | Avoid. The reason is shown. | Check the label or how it is made. |
| **295** allowed | **140** in moderation | **70** avoid | **0** check label |

Brand products vary. This list is built from the FighterBase food catalogue of 505 common foods. If a food is not here, ask which group it belongs to and check the label.

AT A GLANCE

# Low-carb on one page

Cuts back on bread, pasta, rice and sugar, without going as far as keto. Meals lean on protein, veg and healthy fats.

### Mostly yes

- Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet)
- Beef mince (5% to 20% fat)
- Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
- Trout
- Hen eggs (whole)
- Egg whites (carton)
- Spinach
- Kale
- Carrots
- Beetroot
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)

### Mostly no

- Croissants and pastries
- Cakes and sponge
- Sushi rice
- Muesli and granola
- Condensed and evaporated milk
- Ice cream
- Custard and milk puddings
- Baked beans in tomato sauce
- White and brown sugar
- Honey
- Hot chocolate
- Squash and cordial

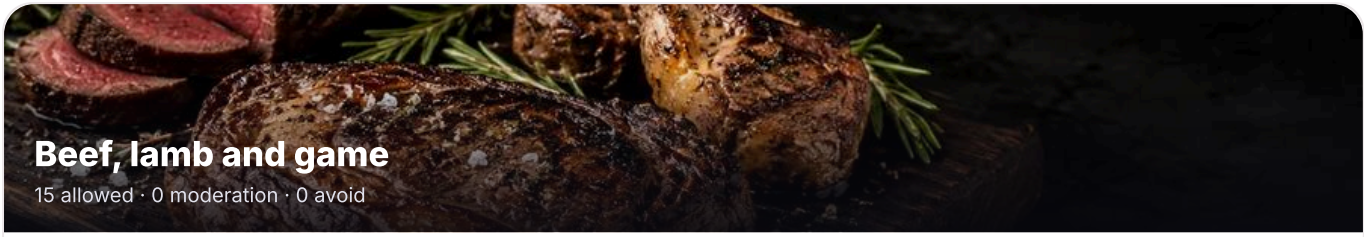
## The big ideas

1. Build meals around protein, non-starchy vegetables and healthy fats.
2. Cut back the big carb sources: bread, pasta, rice, potatoes, sugar, sweet drinks and most cereals.
3. Keep some carbs from vegetables, berries and legumes, depending on how low you go.
4. There is no single carb number. Pick a level you can keep up.
5. Fibre still matters: lots of vegetables, some seeds and nuts.

> **Talk to a professional first if:** You take medication for diabetes or blood pressure (doses can need changing); You have kidney, liver or gall bladder problems; You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18; You have ever had an eating disorder.

THE FULL LIST

# Every food, by type



## Beef, lamb and game

15 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 15**

Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet) · Beef mince (5% to 20% fat) · Beef joint (topside, brisket, silverside) · Beef short ribs and oxtail · Beef burgers (home-made, 100% beef) · Lamb chops, leg and shoulder · Lamb mince · Mutton · Goat · Venison · Rabbit · Wild boar · Bison and buffalo · Pheasant, partridge and grouse · Veal



## Pork and cured meats

5 allowed · 8 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED 5**

Pork loin, chops and tenderloin · Pork belly and pork shoulder · Pork mince · Gammon and ham joint · Lard

**MODERATION 8**

Bacon (back and streaky) · often hides sugar and starch · Sausages (pork) · often hides sugar and starch · Sausages (beef or chicken, check the label) · often hides sugar and starch · Ham slices (deli) · often hides sugar and starch · Salami, chorizo and pepperoni · often hides sugar and starch · Pork pies and scotch eggs · often hides sugar and starch · Pate and liver sausage · often hides sugar and starch · Black pudding · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID 1**

Pulled pork (ready-made, sweetened sauce) · added sugar



## Poultry

8 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 8**

Chicken breast · Chicken thighs and drumsticks (skin on or off) · Whole roast chicken · Chicken wings · Chicken mince · Turkey breast and turkey mince · Duck breast and duck leg · Goose

**MODERATION 3**

Chicken nuggets and breaded chicken · often hides sugar and starch
Chicken sausages and deli chicken slices · often hides sugar and starch
Rotisserie chicken (shop-bought, check seasoning) · often hides sugar and starch



## Offal and bones

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Liver (beef, lamb, chicken)
Kidney
Heart
Tongue
Tripe
Bone marrow
Bone broth (home-made)
Beef dripping and tallow
Duck fat and goose fat
Gelatine and collagen powder



## Fish

26 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 26**

Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
Trout
Mackerel
Sardines (fresh or tinned in oil or water)
Herring and kippers
Anchovies
Pilchards
Tuna (fresh steak)
Tuna (tinned)
Cod
Haddock
Pollock and coley
Plaice and sole
Sea bass and sea bream
Halibut and turbot
Hake
Whitebait
Skate
Monkfish
Swordfish
Catfish
Eel
Shark
Sturgeon and caviar
Fish roe (cod roe, salmon roe)
Cod liver oil

**MODERATION 5**

Smoked salmon · often hides sugar and starch
Fish fingers and breaded fish · often hides sugar and starch
Fish cakes · often hides sugar and starch
Fish paste and pate · often hides sugar and starch
Surimi and crab sticks · often hides sugar and starch



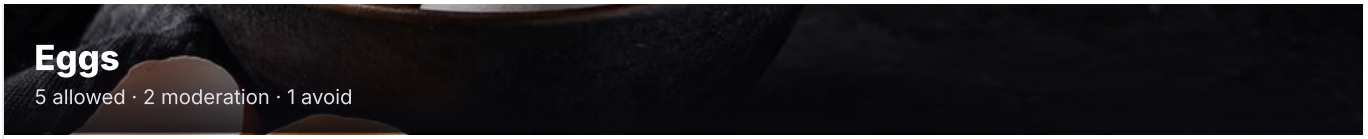
## Shellfish and seafood

13 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 13**

Prawns and shrimp
King prawns and tiger prawns
Crab
Lobster
Langoustine and crayfish
Mussels
Oysters
Scallops
Clams and cockles
Whelks and winkles
Squid and calamari
Octopus
Cuttlefish





## Eggs

5 allowed · 2 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED** 5

Hen eggs (whole) · Egg whites (carton) · Duck eggs · Quail eggs · Omelette and scrambled egg

**MODERATION** 2

Mayonnaise · often hides sugar and starch

Egg noodles · starchy, keep small and around training

**AVOID** 1

Meringue · added sugar



## Milk and cream

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED** 10

Whole milk · Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk · Lactose-free milk · Goat's milk and sheep's milk · Single, double and whipping cream · Soured cream and creme fraiche · Milk powder · Butter · Ghee (clarified butter) · Buttermilk

**AVOID** 1

Condensed and evaporated milk · added sugar



## Yoghurt, kefir and soft cheeses

11 allowed · 0 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED** 11

Plain natural yoghurt · Greek yoghurt · Skyr · Kefir · Cottage cheese · Quark · Cream cheese · Ricotta · Mascarpone · Mozzarella · Paneer

**AVOID** 1

Flavoured and fruit yoghurt · added sugar



## Hard and mature cheeses

9 allowed · 3 moderation · 3 avoid

**ALLOWED** 9

Cheddar · Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet) · Edam and gouda · Emmental and gruyere · Brie and camembert · Blue cheese (stilton, gorgonzola) · Feta · Halloumi · Goat's cheese

**MODERATION** 3

Processed cheese slices and spreads · often hides sugar and starch

Whey protein · often hides sugar and starch

Casein protein · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID** 3

Ice cream · added sugar

Custard and milk puddings · added sugar

Milkshakes · added sugar



## Plant proteins and soy

8 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED** 8

Tofu (firm, silken, smoked)

Tempeh

Edamame

Soya milk and soya yoghurt

Seitan (wheat protein)

Nutritional yeast

Miso

Natto

**MODERATION** 4

Soya mince and soya chunks · often hides sugar and starch

Quorn and mycoprotein (many contain egg white) · often hides sugar and starch

Plant-based burgers and sausages · often hides sugar and starch

Pea protein and rice protein powder · often hides sugar and starch



## Beans, lentils and pulses

8 allowed · 15 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED** 8

Broad beans

Lupin beans

Hummus

Peanuts

Peanut butter

Green beans and runner beans

Garden peas and petits pois

Mangetout and sugar snap peas

**MODERATION** 15

Red lentils · starchy, keep small and around training

Green and brown lentils · starchy, keep small and around training

Puy lentils · starchy, keep small and around training

Chickpeas · starchy, keep small and around training

Black beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Kidney beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Cannellini and haricot beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Butter beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Pinto beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Borlotti beans · starchy, keep small and around training

Black-eyed peas · starchy, keep small and around training

Split peas · starchy, keep small and around training

Falafel · often hides sugar and starch

Refried beans · often hides sugar and starch

Bean and lentil pasta · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID** 1

Baked beans in tomato sauce · added sugar



## Bread and bakery

3 allowed · 17 moderation · 6 avoid

**ALLOWED 3**

- Almond-flour bread and wraps
- Coconut-flour wraps
- Cloud bread

**MODERATION 17**

- White bread · starchy, keep small and around training
- Wholemeal and granary bread · starchy, keep small and around training
- Sourdough bread · starchy, keep small and around training
- Rye bread · starchy, keep small and around training
- Seeded bread · starchy, keep small and around training
- Gluten-free bread · often hides sugar and starch
- Pitta and flatbreads · starchy, keep small and around training
- Wraps and tortillas (wheat) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Corn tortillas · starchy, keep small and around training
- Naan and chapati · starchy, keep small and around training
- Bagels · starchy, keep small and around training
- Crumpets and muffins · starchy, keep small and around training
- Pizza base · starchy, keep small and around training
- Crackers and crispbreads · starchy, keep small and around training
- Oatcakes · starchy, keep small and around training
- Rice cakes · starchy, keep small and around training
- Pies and pasties · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID 6**

- Croissants and pastries · added sugar
- Cakes and sponge · added sugar
- Biscuits and cookies · added sugar
- Doughnuts · added sugar
- Cereal bars and flapjacks · added sugar
- Protein bars · added sugar



## Pasta, rice and grains

6 allowed · 32 moderation · 3 avoid

**ALLOWED 6**

- Chia pudding
- Cauliflower rice
- Courgette noodles (courgetti)
- Konjac (shirataki) noodles
- Flours: almond
- Flours: coconut

**MODERATION 32**

- Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Egg pasta and fresh pasta · starchy, keep small and around training
- Gluten-free pasta (corn or rice) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Noodles (wheat) and ramen · starchy, keep small and around training
- Rice noodles · starchy, keep small and around training
- Glass noodles · starchy, keep small and around training
- Couscous · starchy, keep small and around training
- Bulgur wheat · starchy, keep small and around training
- Semolina · starchy, keep small and around training
- Freekeh, spelt, farro and kamut · starchy, keep small and around training
- Barley and pearl barley · starchy, keep small and around training
- White rice (basmati, jasmine, long-grain) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Brown rice · starchy, keep small and around training
- Wild rice · starchy, keep small and around training
- Risotto rice · starchy, keep small and around training
- Oats (rolled and porridge) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Oat bran · starchy, keep small and around training
- Shredded wheat and wheat biscuits · starchy, keep small and around training
- Quinoa · starchy, keep small and around training
- Buckwheat · starchy, keep small and around training
- Amaranth · starchy, keep small and around training
- Millet · starchy, keep small and around training
- Sorghum · starchy, keep small and around training
- Teff · starchy, keep small and around training
- Polenta and cornmeal · starchy, keep small and around training
- Sweetcorn and corn on the cob · starchy, keep small and around training
- Popcorn · starchy, keep small and around training
- Tortilla chips · often hides sugar and starch
- Flours: wheat and plain · starchy, keep small and around training
- Flours: rice, cornflour and maize · starchy, keep small and around training
- Flours: chickpea (gram) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Flours: tapioca and arrowroot · starchy, keep small and around training

**AVOID 3**

- Sushi rice · added sugar
- Muesli and granola · added sugar
- Breakfast cereals (cornflakes, bran flakes) · added sugar

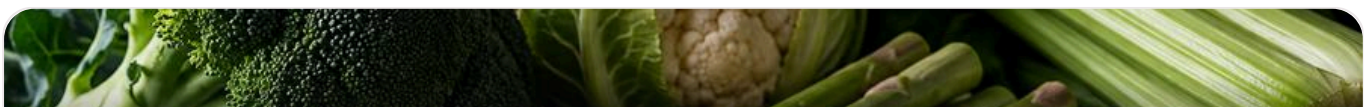


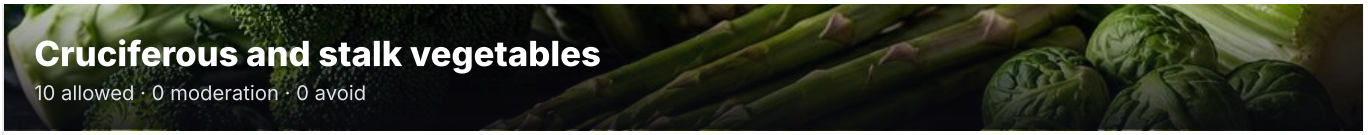
## Leafy and salad vegetables

12 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 12**

- Spinach
- Kale
- Cabbage (green, red, savoy)
- Spring greens and collards
- Lettuce and salad leaves
- Rocket and watercress
- Chard
- Pak choi and bok choy
- Cucumber
- Celery
- Radishes
- Bean sprouts





## Cruciferous and stalk vegetables

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Broccoli · Cauliflower · Brussels sprouts · Asparagus · Fennel · Artichoke · Kohlrabi · Leeks · Courgette and marrow · Aubergine



## Onions, peppers and tomatoes

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Onions and shallots · Garlic · Spring onions and chives · Peppers (red, green, yellow) · Chillies · Tomatoes (fresh, tinned, passata) · Tomato puree · Mushrooms (all types) · Olives · Avocado



## Roots, squash and starchy vegetables

14 allowed · 10 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 14**

Carrots · Beetroot · Parsnips · Swede and turnip · Celeriac · Butternut squash and pumpkin · Jerusalem artichoke · Seaweed and nori · Sauerkraut · Kimchi · Pickles and gherkins · Frozen vegetables (plain) · Tinned vegetables (no added sugar) · Vegetable juice

**MODERATION 10**

- Sweet potato · starchy, keep small and around training
- White potatoes (boiled, baked, mashed) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Chips (home-made, oven) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Chips and fries (takeaway or frozen) · starchy, keep small and around training
- Roast potatoes · starchy, keep small and around training
- Yam · starchy, keep small and around training
- Cassava (yuca) and tapioca · starchy, keep small and around training
- Plantain · starchy, keep small and around training
- Taro · starchy, keep small and around training
- Parsnip and potato crisps (vegetable crisps) · often hides sugar and starch



## Fruit

16 allowed · 12 moderation · 8 avoid

**ALLOWED** 16

Strawberries · Blueberries · Raspberries · Blackberries · Cranberries and redcurrants · Lemons and limes · Grapefruit · Peaches and nectarines · Plums · Apricots · Kiwi · Melon (cantaloupe, honeydew) · Watermelon · Papaya · Passion fruit · Coconut (fresh flesh)

**MODERATION** 12

Apples · fruit sugars add up · Pears · fruit sugars add up · Oranges and satsumas · fruit sugars add up · Cherries · fruit sugars add up · Pineapple · fruit sugars add up · Mango · fruit sugars add up · Grapes · fruit sugars add up · Bananas · fruit sugars add up · Figs (fresh) · fruit sugars add up · Pomegranate · fruit sugars add up · Smoothies (home-made, whole fruit) · fruit sugars add up · Coconut water · fruit sugars add up

**AVOID** 8

Dates · added sugar · Raisins, sultanas and currants · added sugar · Dried apricots, figs and prunes · added sugar · Other dried fruit and fruit leather · added sugar · Tinned fruit in juice · added sugar · Tinned fruit in syrup · added sugar · Fruit juice · added sugar · Smoothies (shop-bought) · added sugar



## Nuts and seeds

20 allowed · 2 moderation · 2 avoid

**ALLOWED** 20

Almonds · Walnuts · Cashews · Pecans · Hazelnuts · Brazil nuts · Macadamias · Pistachios · Pine nuts · Mixed nuts (plain) · Chia seeds · Flaxseed (linseed) · Hemp seeds · Pumpkin seeds · Sunflower seeds · Sesame seeds and tahini · Poppy seeds · Almond butter · Cashew butter · Coconut flakes and desiccated coconut

**MODERATION** 2

Chestnuts · starchy, keep small and around training · Salted and flavoured nuts · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID** 2

Trail mix (with dried fruit and chocolate) · added sugar · Hazelnut chocolate spread · added sugar



## Oils, fats and spreads

13 allowed · 3 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED** 13

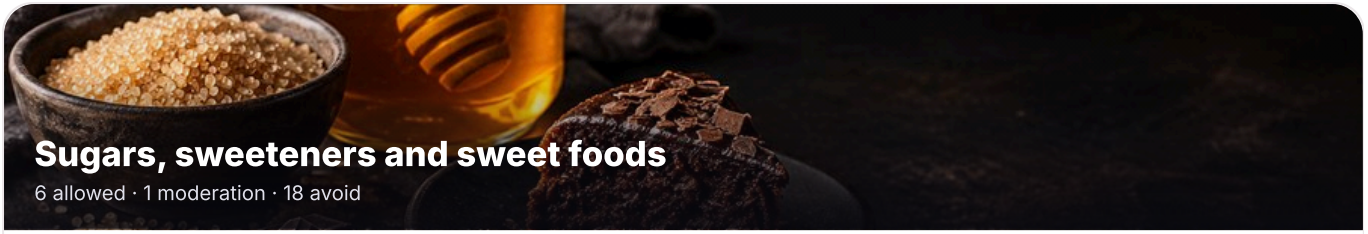
Extra virgin olive oil · Olive oil (light) · Avocado oil · Coconut oil · MCT oil · Flaxseed oil · Walnut oil · Sesame oil · Rapeseed (canola) oil · Sunflower oil · Vegetable oil and corn oil · Soybean oil · Palm oil

**MODERATION** 3

Margarine and baking spreads · often hides sugar and starch · Dairy-free spreads · often hides sugar and starch · Cooking spray · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID** 1

Salad dressings (bottled) · added sugar



## Sugars, sweeteners and sweet foods

6 allowed · 1 moderation · 18 avoid

**ALLOWED 6**

Stevia · Monk fruit · Erythritol and xylitol · Aspartame, sucralose and saccharin · Dark chocolate 85% or higher · Cocoa powder (unsweetened)

**MODERATION 1**

Protein ice cream and low-sugar desserts · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID 18**

White and brown sugar · added sugar · Honey · added sugar · Maple syrup · added sugar · Agave syrup · added sugar · Golden syrup, treacle and molasses · added sugar · Date syrup and date paste · added sugar · Coconut sugar · added sugar · Jam, marmalade and fruit spreads · added sugar · Milk chocolate · added sugar · Dark chocolate 70% or higher · added sugar · White chocolate · added sugar · Sweets, gummies and jelly · added sugar · Marshmallows · added sugar · Fizzy and boiled sweets · added sugar · Energy gels and chews · added sugar · Sherbet and candyfloss · added sugar · Fruit pastilles and wine gums · added sugar · Vegan chocolate · added sugar



## Herbs, spices and flavourings

16 allowed · 2 moderation · 1 avoid

**ALLOWED 16**

Salt (sea, table, rock) · Black pepper · Basil, oregano, thyme and rosemary · Parsley, coriander, mint and dill · Sage, bay and tarragon · Cumin, coriander seed and fennel seed · Turmeric · Paprika and smoked paprika · Chilli flakes and cayenne · Cinnamon, nutmeg and cloves · Ginger (fresh and ground) · Garlic powder and onion powder · Mustard seeds · Vanilla (pods) · Curry powder and garam masala (check blends) · Mixed herbs and Italian seasoning

**MODERATION 2**

Vanilla extract (alcohol-based) · alcohol · Stock cubes and gravy granules · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID 1**

Seasoning mixes and rubs (check label) · added sugar



## Sauces and condiments

15 allowed · 1 moderation · 12 avoid

**ALLOWED 15**

Mustard (English, Dijon, wholegrain) · Soy sauce · Tamari (wheat-free soy sauce) · Coconut aminos · Fish sauce · Worcestershire sauce · Hot sauce (chilli) · Apple cider vinegar · White wine, red wine and rice vinegar · Malt vinegar · Pesto (basil and pine nut) · Dairy-free pesto · Salsa · Guacamole · Gravy (home-made, no flour)

**MODERATION 1**

Mayonnaise (light) · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID 12**

Tomato ketchup · added sugar · Brown sauce · added sugar · BBQ sauce · added sugar · Oyster sauce · added sugar · Sriracha · added sugar · Balsamic vinegar · added sugar · Curry sauce (jar) · added sugar · Pasta sauce (jar) · added sugar · Sweet chilli sauce · added sugar · Teriyaki sauce · added sugar · Hoisin sauce · added sugar · Coleslaw (shop-bought) · added sugar



## Drinks

13 allowed · 6 moderation · 8 avoid

**ALLOWED 13**

Water (still and sparkling) · Tea (black, green, white) · Herbal and fruit teas · Coffee (black) · Coffee with milk or cream · Decaffeinated coffee and tea · Electrolyte tablets and powders (sugar-free) · Oat milk · Almond, cashew and hazelnut milk · Coconut milk drink · Pea milk · Alcohol-free beer · Bone broth drink

**MODERATION 6**

Diet and zero-sugar fizzy drinks · often hides sugar and starch · Rice milk · starchy, keep small and around training · Beer and lager · alcohol · Wine (red, white, rose) · alcohol · Spirits (whisky, gin, vodka, rum) · alcohol · Gluten-free beer · alcohol

**AVOID 8**

Hot chocolate · added sugar · Squash and cordial · added sugar · Fizzy drinks (cola, lemonade) · added sugar · Energy drinks · added sugar · Sports drinks · added sugar · Kombucha · added sugar · Cider · added sugar · Liqueurs and alcopops · added sugar



## Ready meals and takeaway

3 allowed · 12 moderation · 3 avoid

**ALLOWED 3**

Home-made vegetable soup · Salad with grilled chicken · Stir-fry (home-made)

**MODERATION** 12

Pizza · often hides sugar and starch
Burgers in buns · often hides sugar and starch
Kebabs · often hides sugar and starch
Fish and chips · often hides sugar and starch
Sushi · starchy, keep small and around training
Sandwiches and subs · often hides sugar and starch
Crisps · often hides sugar and starch
Pot noodles and instant noodles · often hides sugar and starch
Tinned soup (check label) · often hides sugar and starch
Sausage rolls · often hides sugar and starch
Jacket potato with filling · starchy, keep small and around training
Burrito and fajitas · often hides sugar and starch

**AVOID** 3

Takeaway curry with rice · added sugar
Chinese takeaway · added sugar
Ready meals · added sugar



## Supplements

10 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED** 10

Creatine monohydrate
Fish oil (omega-3)
Algae omega-3
Vitamin D3 (from lanolin)
Vitamin D (from lichen)
Multivitamin and mineral tablet
Magnesium
Caffeine tablets
BCAAs and EAAs
Collagen peptides

**MODERATION** 2

Pea or rice protein · often hides sugar and starch
Soy protein · often hides sugar and starch

READ THE LABEL

# Hidden ingredients

Ingredients can hide in the small print. Look for these on packaging, menus and supplements.

- Sugar can hide as: dextrose, maltodextrin, glucose syrup, honey, agave, fruit juice concentrate
- 'Sugar-free' foods can still carry starch or sugar alcohols (maltitol, sorbitol)
- Look at total carbohydrate per portion, not just 'of which sugars'

## For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

# Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.